Karim Elsarha

Inventory Planning & Control Manager

Inventory Planning · Warehousing · Procurement · SAP MM

18 years across procurement, inventory, and cost accounting. I run inventory planning and control for 9 warehouse sites across SCZONE's ports and industrial zones, and I led the SAP MM workstream to go-live in January 2026.

- Nationality: Egyptian
- Available to join within one month
- Open to relocation (KSA/GCC)



About

A Career Built on Trust, Numbers & Negotiation



Karim Elsarha

SCZONE · Cairo, Egypt

Inventory planning and procurement professional with 18 years in Egypt's port and economic-zone sector: eight years in budgeting and cost accounting at the Red Sea Ports Authority, almost nine heading a procurement section at SCZONE, and since January 2025, head of SCZONE's Inventory Planning & Control Department.

I care about turning operations into clear systems, whether a procurement cycle, a supplier relationship, or a warehouse process, and I'm always looking for the next challenge where that discipline adds real value.

18+
Years of Experience

25
Team Members Led

9
Warehouse Sites

1,500+
Suppliers Registered

Experience

A Track Record Across the Full Supply Chain

Inventory Planning & Control Manager

Jan 2025 – Present

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt

23%	0	1,700	9	25
↓ On-Hand Stock (FY24/25)	Stock Variance, 2 Annual Counts	Employees' Custody Digitized	Warehouse Sites	Staff Trained on SAP MM

- ✓ Selected by executive management to lead the department: 25 staff (1 department manager, 2 section heads, 8 inventory specialists and accountants, 14 storekeepers), including their performance appraisals.
- ✓ Oversaw the FY2024/25 excess-stock drawdown: total on-hand units down 23% (124.6K to 96.4K) with no disruption to issuing or operations. Office-supply replenishment fell 95% year over year, and a full year of copy-paper demand was covered from existing stock.
- ✓ Led the SAP MM workstream (procurement and inventory) through a 4-year ERP implementation that went live in January 2026. Owned all MM master data and directed the team that extracted and cleansed it, then reviewed and validated it before handover to the implementation partner.
- ✓ Built and maintains the department's inventory database and reporting tools (Python, SQL, Power BI), and rolled out barcode tracking at 4 of 9 sites, with the rest underway.
- ✓ Authored SCZONE's new Warehouse Management Regulation (13 chapters plus appendices) covering receiving, issuing, returns, custody, and stock security; now in legal review ahead of approval.
- ✓ Plans inventory and replenishment for 400+ SKUs using ABC analysis, Min-Max levels, reorder points, and consumption-based forecasts by site and category, configured in SAP MM and the department's inventory database.
- ✓ Zero variance between physical and book balances in 2 consecutive annual physical inventories, backed by quarterly cycle counts and stock reconciliation with Finance.
- ✓ Trained all 25 warehouse staff hands-on on SAP MM, from receipt to issue, and defined role-based authorizations for each user.
- ✓ Digitized custody tracking for 1,700 employees, replacing paper records. Retrieving an employee's full custody history now takes under a minute instead of several days.
- ✓ Runs an annual cycle to identify and sell slow-moving and scrap items (about 50 slow-moving and 1,000 scrap line items per cycle), and works daily with Procurement on requisitions, specifications, and delivery schedules.

Procurement Section Head

May 2016 – Jan 2025

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt

EGP 50.3M	21%	1,500+
Contract Awards (2022, co-managed)	Below Estimated Cost (2022)	Suppliers Registered

- ✓ Headed a procurement section that grew from 3 to 8 staff (one of two section heads in the Contracts Department), covering the full sourcing cycle (RFQ, tender, evaluation, award, contract) for goods, works, and services across SCZONE's ports and industrial zones.
- ✓ Supervised every stage of the government procurement cycle for direct purchases, tenders, and public auctions: budget confirmation, tender documents and advertising, committee formation, bid opening and evaluation, award, contract drafting, and supplier performance follow-up. In 2022 this covered 15 competitive procedures, 115 direct orders, 79 tender packages, and 18 contracts.
- ✓ Led procurement for a new Vessel Traffic System (VTS) tower at Ain Sokhna Port with no prior specifications or in-house expertise. Brought in the Suez Canal Authority at no added cost to help write the specifications and tender documents. Awarded to the lowest bidder with current-generation technology, from planning to final acceptance in 8 months.
- ✓ Handled international procurement for port systems: a gas pressure-reduction station (Pietro Fiorentini, Italy), tugboat spare parts (MAPSO, Switzerland), and navigation equipment (Vissim, Norway), including letters of credit and customs clearance.
- ✓ Co-authored SCZONE's Procurement & Contracts Regulations as part of a 5-member team; approved and still in effect.
- ✓ Co-managed EGP 50.3M in contract awards in 2022 (EGP 31.6M by tender, EGP 18.7M by direct purchase), awarded 16% below estimated cost on tenders and 29% below on direct purchases, about EGP 13.7M (21%) saved overall.
- ✓ Ran vendor registration and qualification for a supplier base of 1,500+ vendors (265 added in 2022 alone), and evaluated bids on price, technical compliance, delivery terms, and service quality.
- ✓ Renewed maintenance contracts for 300+ copiers across 6 ports and 4 industrial zones, rejecting the supplier's 10% price increase through market benchmarking and negotiation; renewed at unchanged prices with full maintenance and spare-parts coverage.
- ✓ Sourced high-value goods and works, including fire-fighting network upgrades, explosive-detection systems, maintenance of a 22 kV ring main unit at East Port Said, and 147 PCs for government entities.

Budgeting & Cost Accountant

Jun 2008 – May 2016

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA) — Suez, Egypt

- ✓ Collected, analyzed, and reported operational cost data to support management decision-making and cost control.
- ✓ Helped prepare and consolidate RSPA's annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts.
- ✓ Collaborated with department heads to gather budget inputs and align them with organizational strategy.
- ✓ Assessed the financial impact of changes in goods and services on overall operational costs.
- ✓ Monitored budget performance through the fiscal year, identified variances, and recommended corrective actions.

This is where my budgeting, feasibility-study, and financial-evaluation instincts were formed.

Case Studies

Projects I'm Proud Of

A closer look at how I handle high-stakes problems from start to finish.

Infrastructure Project

Vessel Traffic System (VTS) Navigation Tower, Ain Sokhna Port

THE CHALLENGE

A greenfield, highly technical maritime navigation project, with no existing specifications or in-house technical expertise to build from.

Approach

- ✓ Mapped the technical and operational risks from the ground up and built a standard reference model for the project.
- ✓ Formed a cost-neutral partnership with the Suez Canal Authority to bring in specialized maritime expertise.
- ✓ Co-developed precise tender documents aligned with international maritime standards.

Results & Impact

- ★ Awarded the contract below comparable market rates, while securing the latest available technology.
- ★ Delivered full procurement, installation, and commissioning in 8 months.
- ★ Improved maritime safety, traffic monitoring, and real-time vessel tracking at the port.

Strategic Planning

Enterprise Inventory Control & Strategic Planning — SCZONE

THE SCOPE

Inventory planning and control for 400+ SKUs across 9 warehouse sites in SCZONE's ports and industrial zones.

Approach

- ✓ Set Min-Max levels and reorder points by site and category, using ABC analysis and consumption-based forecasts.
- ✓ Catalogued, photographed, and condition-assessed terminal telecom and IT equipment for full audit transparency.
- ✓ Ran multi-year trend analysis on operational supplies to guide smarter resource allocation.

Results & Impact

- ★ Oversaw the FY2024/25 drawdown: on-hand units down 23% (124.6K to 96.4K) with no disruption to issuing.
- ★ Zero variance between physical and book balances in 2 consecutive annual counts, backed by quarterly cycle counts.
- ★ An annual cycle identifies and sells slow-moving and scrap items: about 50 slow-moving and 1,000 scrap line items per cycle.

ERP Implementation

SAP MM Implementation, SCZONE

THE SCOPE

A 4-year ERP project to move SCZONE's procurement and inventory operations onto SAP MM.

Approach

- ✓ Owned the MM module for both procurement and inventory, starting in the procurement role and continuing as head of inventory.
- ✓ Directed the team that extracted and cleansed all MM master data, then reviewed and validated it before handover to the implementation partner.
- ✓ Trained all 25 warehouse staff hands-on, from receipt to issue, and defined role-based authorizations for each user.

Results & Impact

- ★ Went live in January 2026.
- ★ Min-Max levels are now configured in SAP MM alongside the department's own database.
- ★ Every warehouse user has system access matched to their role.

Individual Initiative

Warehouse & Custody System Automation

THE CHALLENGE

Custody records were kept on paper and in scattered Excel files. Finding an employee's custody items or processing a return meant searching file by file.

Approach

- ✓ Started by consolidating the records into one database with Excel Power Query, Power BI, and Access, searchable by employee name.
- ✓ Then built a web application (Python, Flask, SQLite) to replace the manual Excel and Power Query workflow for tracking employee custody items (issue, return, addition).
- ✓ Structured the system around two core functions: personal custody tracking and returns processing.

Impact

- ★ Covers custody records for 1,700 employees and is in use by SCZONE's custody and returns staff.
- ★ Retrieving an employee's full custody history now takes under a minute instead of several days.
- ★ Built individually, with no external vendor or system integrator.

Individual Initiative

Warehouse Regulations Framework

THE CHALLENGE

SCZONE had no formal warehouse regulation. Inventory and custody procedures relied on informal practice instead of a documented framework.

Approach

- ✓ Benchmarked reference frameworks, including those of the Ministry of Communications, the Financial Regulatory Authority, West Delta Electricity, and the government's standard warehouse regulations.
- ✓ Drafted the full Warehouse Regulation: 13 chapters plus appendices, based on Egyptian government references and international standards, including ISO 55000 and CIPS. Used AI tools to speed up research and drafting.
- ✓ Now in legal review ahead of formal approval.

Status & Impact

- ★ Once approved, it will be SCZONE's first documented warehouse regulation.
- ★ Prepared individually, without external consultancy support.
- ★ Reflects the same regulatory drafting and benchmarking discipline that goes into any large-scale governance framework.

Team Project · 5 Members

Procurement & Contracts Regulations

THE CHALLENGE

I was part of a 5-person team that built SCZONE's unified procurement and contracts regulations.

Approach

- ✓ Each team member reviewed the procurement regulations of a reference organization and extracted the clauses that best fit SCZONE's operations.
- ✓ The team consolidated the findings in a joint working session and merged the best-fit provisions into one framework.
- ✓ Co-authored the first draft of the unified regulations with the team.

Results & Impact

- ★ Formally approved and still in effect at SCZONE.
- ★ Gave the department a single, consistent reference for procurement decisions instead of scattered practices.
- ★ Built cross-team consensus-building and drafting skills directly transferable to any multi-party negotiation.

Entrepreneurship

NOGA Café: Entrepreneurship

THE SCOPE

A café venture where I built the business plan and the operating setup, from feasibility to procurement and inventory.

Approach

- ✓ Built the business model, operating concept, and financial feasibility study.
- ✓ Built CAPEX, OPEX, pricing, break-even, and scenario-planning models.
- ✓ Set up the procurement, inventory, and demand-planning processes.

Results & Impact

- ★ Produced an integrated business model covering the commercial, operational, and financial sides.
- ★ Set up a data-based foundation for demand forecasting and inventory decisions.

Core Competencies

Skills & Competencies

Negotiation & Stakeholder Relations

- Strategic Negotiation
- Long-Term Relationship Building
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Commercial Evaluation & RFP Management
- Tendering (RFQ/ITB/RFP)

Contracts, Trade & Compliance

- Contract Drafting, Review & Follow-Up
- FIDIC & USAID Procurement Rules (working knowledge)
- International Trade & Letters of Credit (LCs)
- Official Correspondence & Memo Drafting
- Contract Management
- Green Procurement

Financial & Strategic Analysis

- Budget Planning & Management
- Feasibility Studies & Market Research
- Investor Evaluation Frameworks
- Strategic Planning

Inventory & Technology

- SAP MM & Demand Forecasting
- Min-Max, ABC Analysis & Cycle Counting
- Power BI & Advanced Excel / PowerPoint
- Python & SQL for Inventory Reporting
- Master Data Management

Additional Projects

More Work Across the Procurement Lifecycle

General Procurement Projects

End-to-end procurement of vehicles, IT equipment, office furniture, and critical spare parts.

Infrastructure Upgrade Projects

Procurement and coordination for major infrastructure works: the Ain Sokhna Port VTS navigation tower (with Suez Canal Authority support at no added cost, awarded to the lowest bidder, delivered in 8 months), the Adabiya Port development, and a complete sewage-station installation.

Security & Safety Systems Projects

Sourcing and implementation of fire-suppression networks, explosive-detection devices, and investor communication systems.

International Import Projects

Cross-border procurement of navigation equipment (Vissim, Norway), tugboat spare parts (Mapso, Switzerland), and a gas pressure-reduction station (Pietro Fiorentini, Italy), including letters of credit and customs clearance.

Consultancy & Technical Studies Projects

Collaboration with global consultants on Ain Sokhna Port environmental studies, and procurement supervision for the Port Said Quays development program.

Education & Certifications

Continuous Learning, Purposefully Applied

Education

Master's Degree in Supply Chain Management

Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT) · In Progress, expected August 2027

Coursework: Strategic Planning, Operations, Lean Six Sigma, Quality Control

Bachelor's Degree in Commerce (Accounting)

Suez University, Egypt

Associate Degree in Management Information Systems

Suez Higher Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt

Certifications

- **PMP, Project Management Professional**
  PMI · Expected Dec 2026
- **CPIM, Certified in Planning and Inventory Management**
  ASCM · Expected Feb 2027
- **LinkedIn Learning (course completions)**
  Become a Supply Chain Manager · Negotiation Skills · Project Management Foundations (Procurement) · Inventory Management Foundations

Training & International Exposure

Representing Egypt on the International Stage

Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar

AIBO / China Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM) — Beijing, China | Jul–Aug 2024

Selected as part of the official Egyptian delegation under China's Global Development Initiative at the New Industrialization Conference, with first-hand exposure to international economic-development and investment-promotion dialogue.

Behavioral Barriers

National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt · 2022

Anti-Corruption Training

National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt · 2022

Contact

Let's Connect

Open to new opportunities in procurement, supply chain, and inventory leadership, in Egypt or internationally.

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New Cairo, Egypt

Available to join within one month · Open to relocation (KSA/GCC)

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